# The 1,000 Startups Report

A plain-English tour of what 1,000 real online businesses actually earn — and the surprising patterns hiding in the numbers.

**1,000**
businesses

**29**
facts on each

**100%**
real, verified money

*Source: TrustMRR directory · data frozen 30 July 2026*

# First: what is TrustMRR?

Think of it as a public leaderboard for online businesses — ranked by how much money they really make.

## The simple idea

Most startups can claim any revenue they like. TrustMRR removes the guessing.

Each business connects its real payment account — the same systems that process their customers' card payments — and the site shows the true numbers, straight from the source.

*So every figure in this report is money that genuinely changed hands. Not a claim. Not an estimate.*

## An everyday analogy

A founder saying "we make $1M" is a restaurant claiming it's always full.

**TrustMRR looks directly at the till receipts. You see exactly what came in.**

# Two words you'll see a lot

Everything in this report is built on these two ideas.

## 1 Revenue

The money a business collects. We look at it over four windows: the last 30 days, 3 months, 12 months, and all-time (since it began).

## 2 MRR

Short for Monthly Recurring Revenue — the steady, predictable income that comes in every month from subscriptions. The gold standard, because you can count on it.

# What each business tells us

For all 1,000 businesses, we know 29 things — grouped into five simple buckets.

**A** **Money**
Revenue over time, monthly income, growth

**B** **What they do**
Industry, product, who they sell to

**C** **Where & who**
Country, website, social following

**D** **How they charge**
Payment system, pricing style

**E** **For sale?**
Whether it's listed, and the asking price

*The money numbers are complete for every single business — which is why we can trust every comparison that follows.*

# The big picture, in three numbers

**$334M**

**earned all-time**

by these 1,000 businesses combined

**$15.6M**

**earned last month**

across every business in the list

**$13.5M**

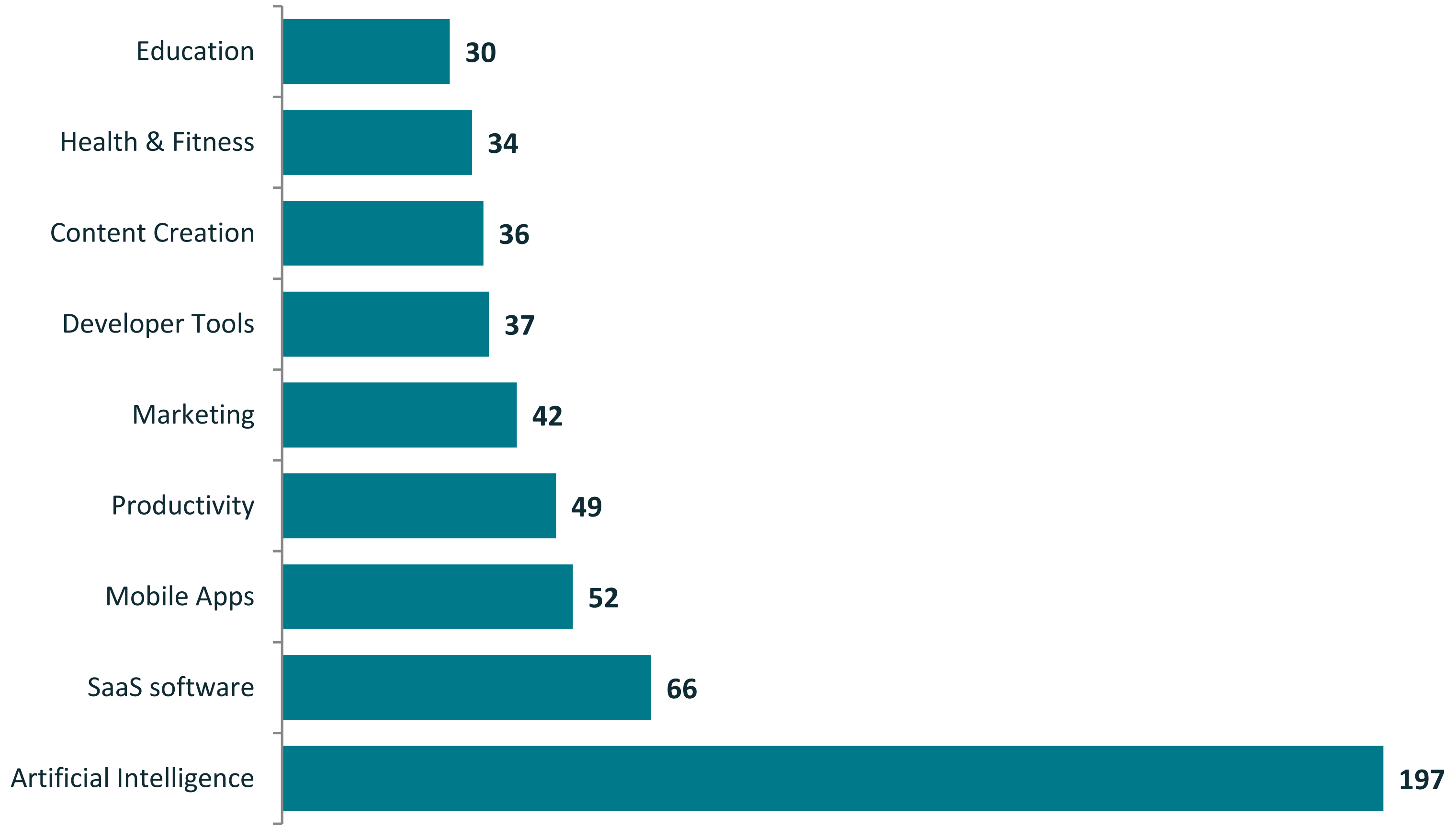
**in monthly recurring revenue**

the steady, predictable slice

*Big totals — but as the next slides show, that money is spread very unevenly.*

# Which industries are they in?

Artificial Intelligence is by far the most crowded space — nearly 1 in every 5 businesses.




## In plain terms

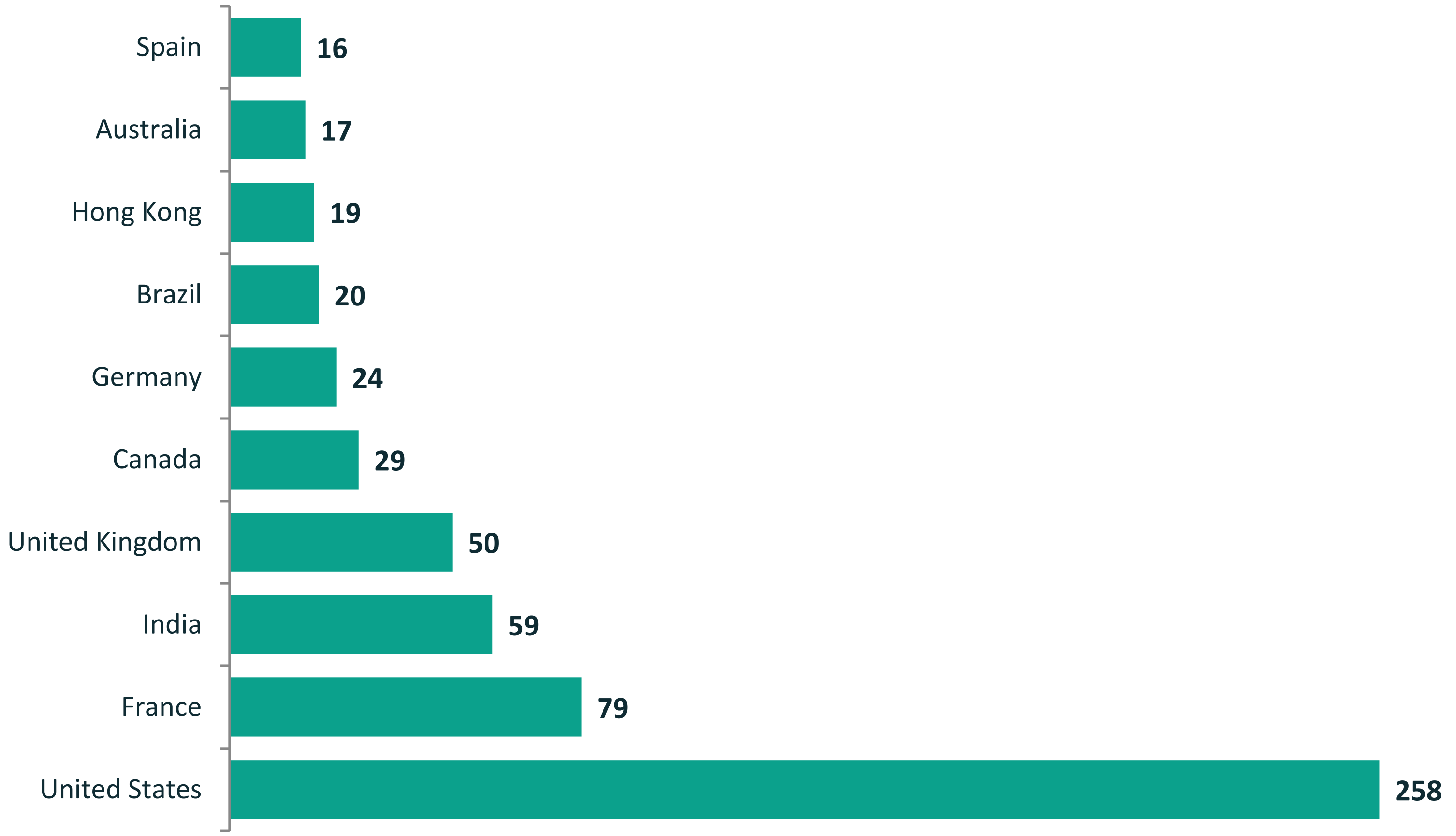
**Everyone is rushing into AI.**

It has almost 3× as many businesses as the next industry.

*But — as we'll see — crowded doesn't mean profitable.*

# Where in the world are they?

The United States leads by a wide margin, followed by France and India.




## Worth noting

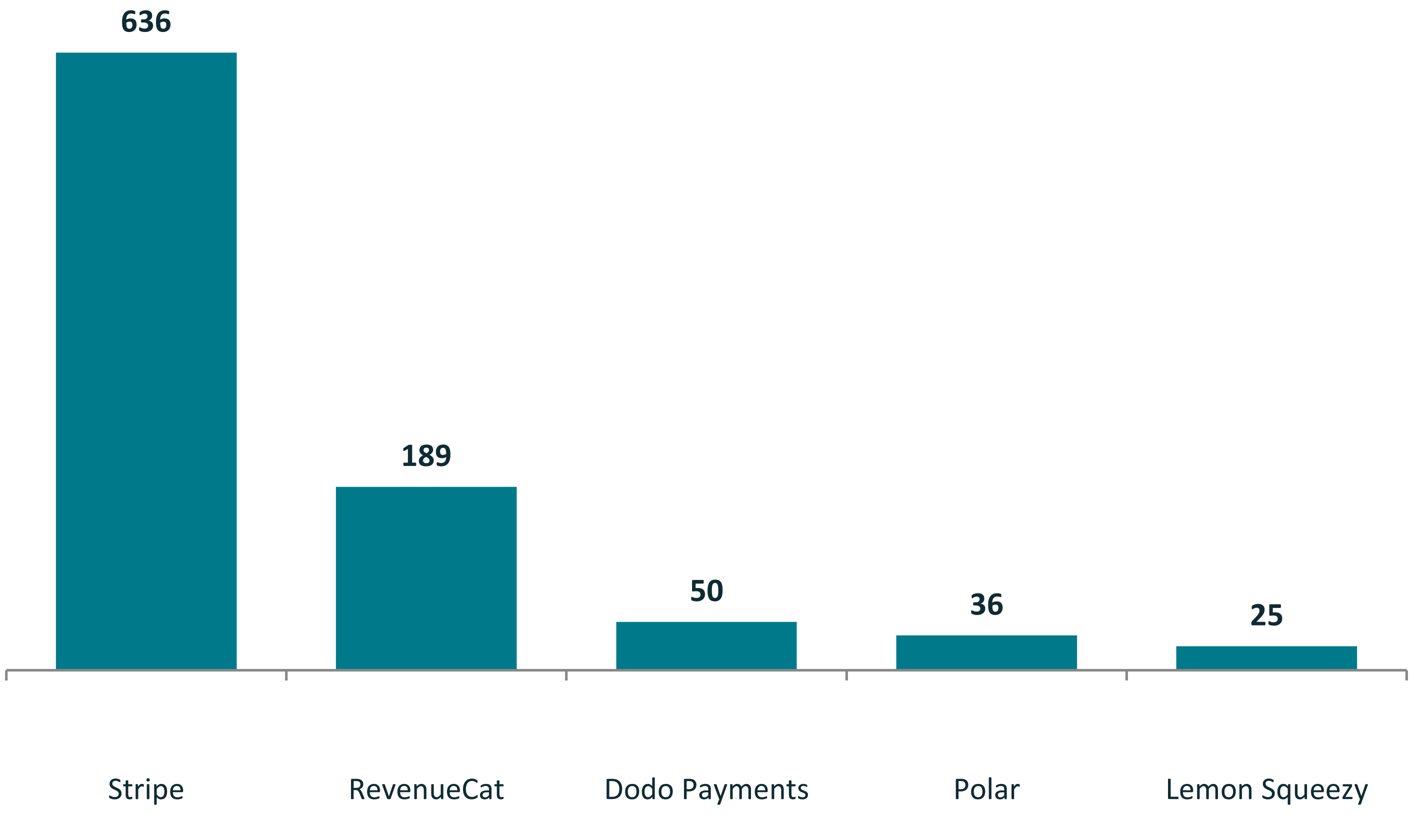
**1 in 4 businesses is American.**

This is a global list, but the United States dominates the map.

*Keep this chart in mind — slide 11 flips it on its head.*

# How do they get paid?

Almost two-thirds run on a single payment system — Stripe.



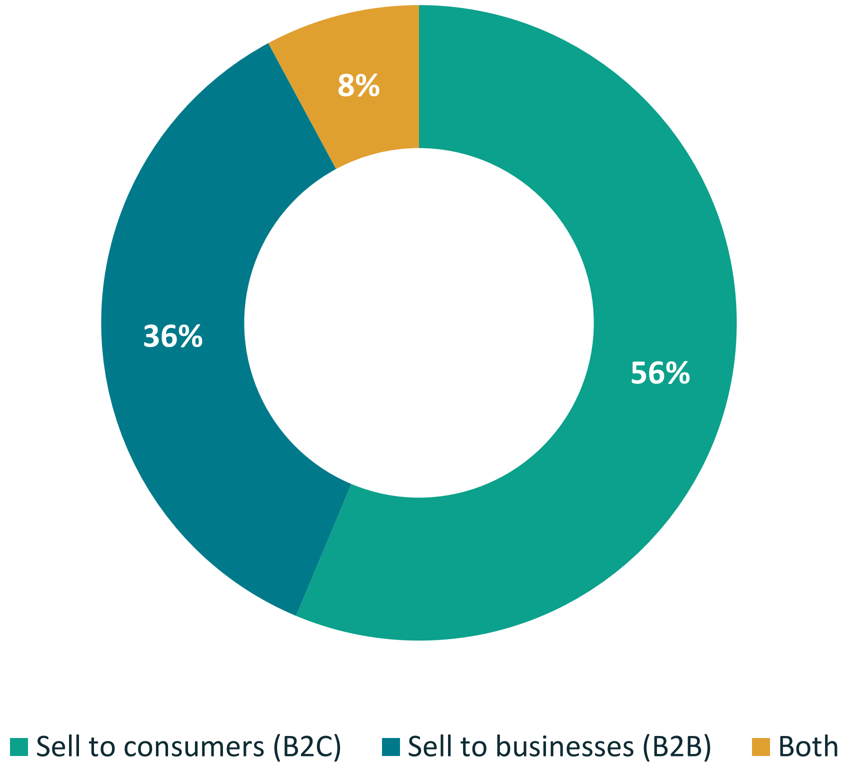

## Why it's interesting

**636 of 1,000 use Stripe.**

Getting paid online used to be hard. Now it’s a solved, shared tool — so founders can focus on the product, not the plumbing.

# Who do they sell to?

Two kinds of customers — and it turns out this choice matters enormously.




## The two types, explained

**B2C — selling to everyday people**

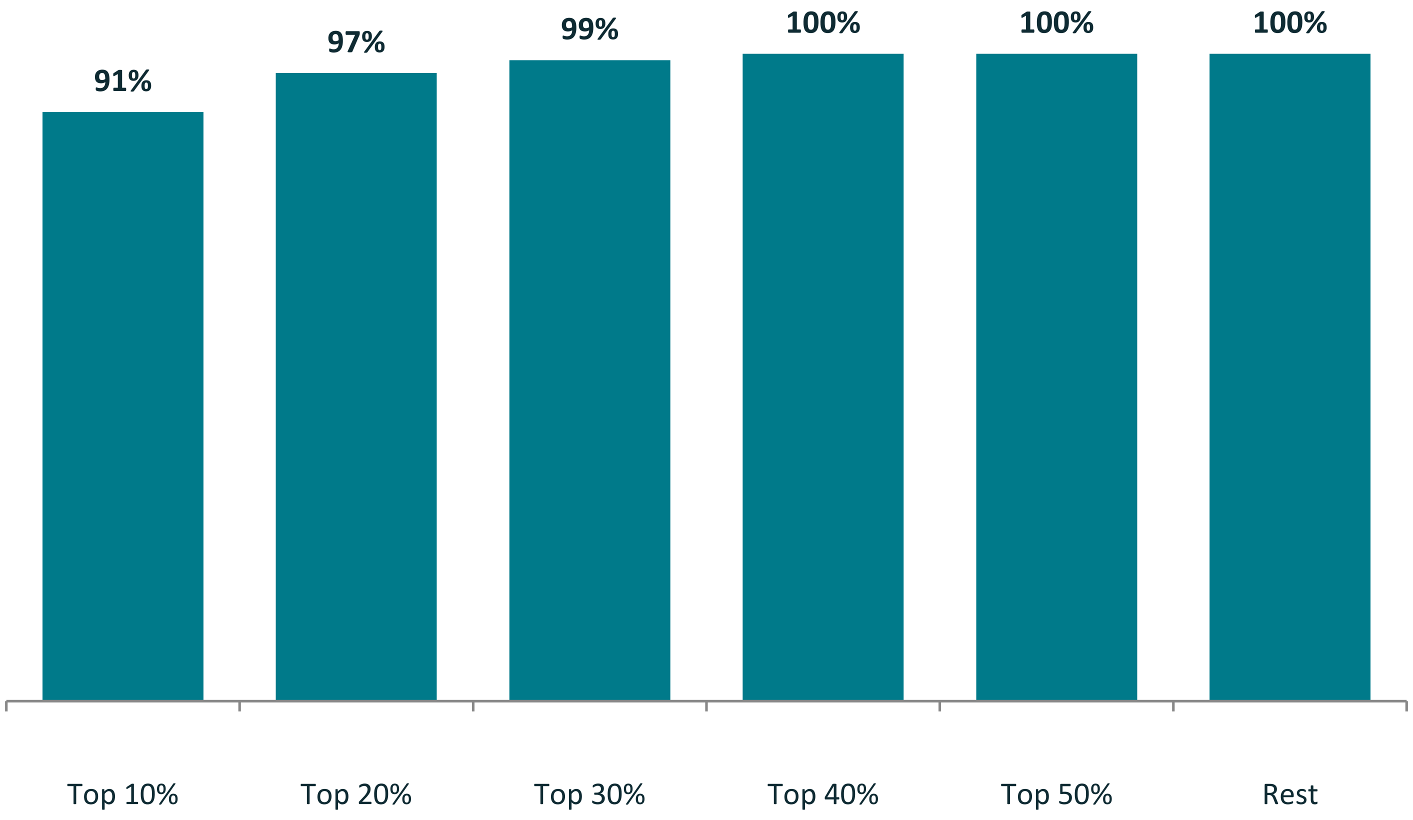
Apps, games, subscriptions. Easy to start, and the biggest group here (4 in 10).

**B2B — selling to other businesses**

Tools and software companies pay for. Fewer of them — but hold that thought for slide 12.

# Surprise 1 — A tiny few earn almost everything

Line up all the money. The top 10% of businesses take home 9 out of every 10 dollars.




## Let that sink in

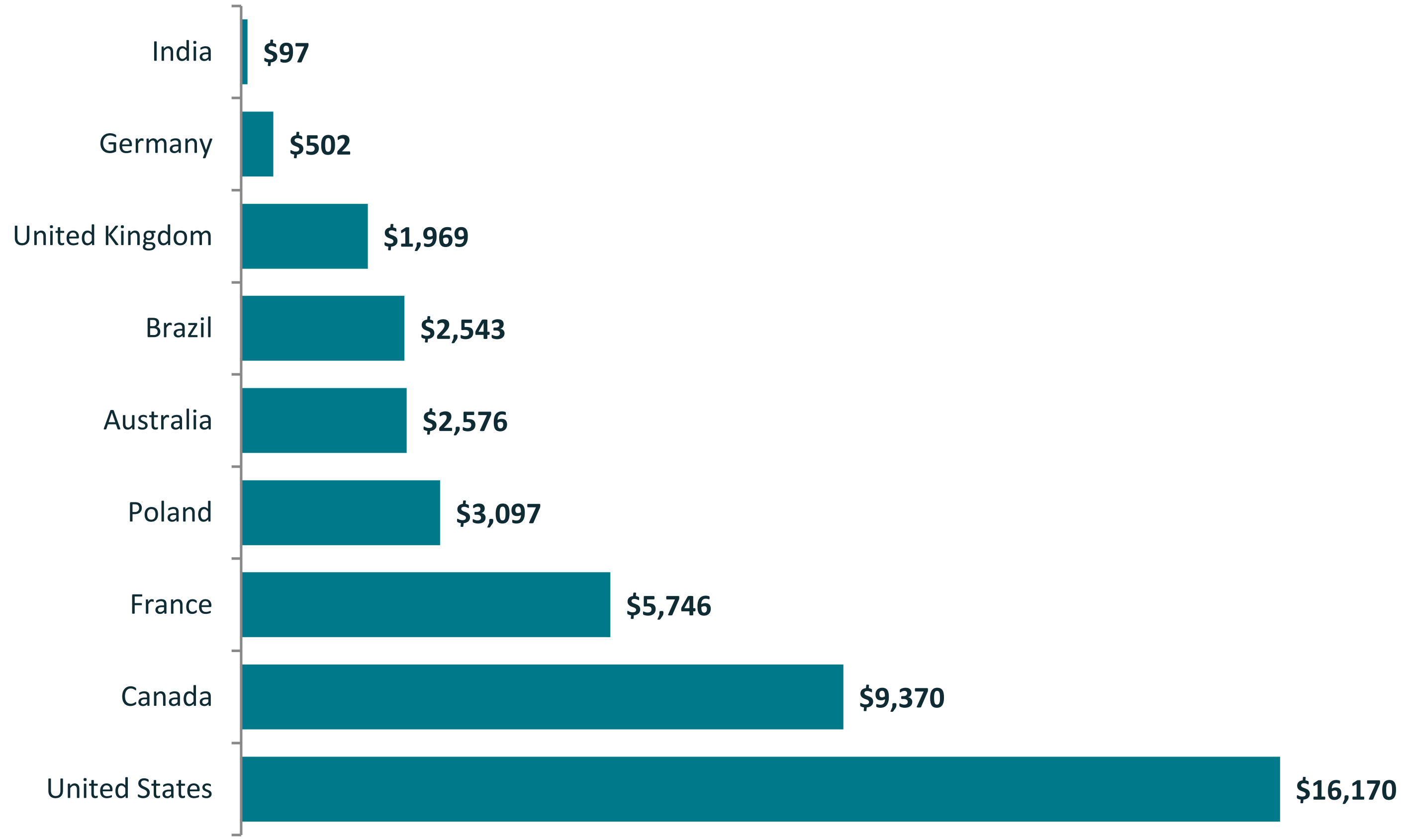
**The single biggest business earns 23% of ALL the money here.**

The bottom 500 businesses — half the entire list — share less than 1% between them.

*This is the most important pattern in the whole report.*

# Surprise 2 — Lots of startups ≠ lots of money

Now the average money earned per business, by country. The map from slide 7 flips completely.




### The twist

**India had the 3rd-most businesses…**

…yet a typical Indian business here earns just $97, versus $16,170 in the United States.

*Having many startups is not the same as earning. India's scene looks early, not yet cashing in.*

# Surprise 3 — Selling to businesses pays far better

There are fewer B2B companies, but a typical one earns about 4× more.


## What it means

**Consumer apps are easy to launch but hard to earn from.**

Businesses pay more, and pay reliably. So a smaller group of B2B companies quietly carries much of the money.

# Surprise 4 — Many are already asleep

1 in 5 businesses earned nothing at all in the last month.

**216**

out of 1,000 businesses made $0 in the last 30 days

### The hidden part

**Some of these once earned real money — then went quiet.**

28 businesses that had earned over $1,000 in their lifetime have now flatlined to zero — roughly $3M of businesses that quietly stopped.

*A quick glance at “total earned” would still call them winners. Looking at last month tells the real story.*

# Surprise 5 — A quarter are for sale (buyer beware)

262 businesses are listed for sale — and the shrinking ones ask for more, not less.

$

## The marketplace

**262 of 1,000**

businesses (about 1 in 4) are openly listed for sale.

Typical asking price: a bit over 2 years’ worth of revenue.

!

## The catch for buyers

**Businesses that are LOSING revenue ask a HIGHER price (relative to earnings) than the average seller.**

In plain terms: some sellers price on hope. A buyer who looks only at the price tag — not whether the business is still growing — can easily overpay for something on its way down.

# The whole report in one minute

1. **What this is** 1,000 real online businesses, ranked by money that genuinely changed hands — no guessing.

2. **A tiny few win big** The top 10% earn 90% of all the money; the biggest single business earns 23% of it.

3. **Count isn't cash** Some countries and industries have many startups but little revenue. Following the crowd ≠ following the money.

4. **Selling to businesses pays** B2B companies are fewer but typically earn about 4× more than consumer apps.

5. **Look closer, not just the headline** 1 in 5 are dormant, and some for-sale businesses are priced on hope. The details change the story.